

Recognising these symptoms across different age groups and lifestyles is the first step towards addressing digital overload and finding a balanced relationship with technology.



PHONE ZOMBIE

Often glued to their screen, the Phone Zombie navigates the world with one eye on their mobile device, barely aware of their surroundings, whether walking down the street or sitting at a dinner table.

- **Neglect of Personal Relationships:** Misses out on real-time conversations and experiences due to constant screen engagement.
- **Physical Discomfort:** Experiences neck and back pain, often referred to as "text neck," from prolonged downward gazing at their phone.
- **Reduced Awareness:** Displays a lack of situational awareness which can sometimes lead to physical accidents or mishaps.
- **Sleep Issues:** Struggles with insomnia or disrupted sleep patterns due to excessive screen time before bed.



SOCIAL MEDIA JUNKIE

With their social media feeds as their world's window, the Social Media Junkie is perpetually posting, scrolling, and updating their status, obsessed with likes, follows, and viral trends.

- **Anxiety from Comparison:** Feels constant pressure and stress from comparing themselves unfavorably with the curated images of others' lives.
- **Mood Fluctuations:** Experiences mood swings based on social media interactions, such as receiving likes or facing online criticism.
- **Neglect of Real-World Activities:** Ignores or avoids activities that can't be shared or aren't 'worthy' of social media.
- **Withdrawal Symptoms:** Feels restless and irritable when unable to check social media platforms regularly.



SEDENTARY WORKAHOLIC

Always connected and always on call, the Workaholic blurs the lines between office hours and personal time, with their digital devices serving as a virtual tether to their work responsibilities.

- **Burnout:** Feels chronic fatigue and a lack of enthusiasm for work which they once found stimulating.
- **Diminished Personal Life:** Has a shrinking social life and minimal personal time due to work commitments dominating their schedule.
- **Physical Health Decline:** Suffers from stress-related ailments such as headaches, muscle tension, and gastrointestinal problems.
- **Cognitive Wear and Tear:** Experiences diminished creativity and problem-solving abilities due to constant task-switching and lack of downtime.



GAMER

Living much of their lives in virtual worlds, Gamers dedicate significant hours to mastering digital landscapes, often at the expense of other aspects of their lives.

- **Social Isolation:** Spends more time interacting with online friends or game characters than with people in real life.
- **Irregular Sleep Patterns:** Exhibits erratic sleeping habits due to late-night gaming sessions that disrupt normal sleep cycles.
- **Physical Strain:** Suffers from eye strain, headaches, and carpal tunnel syndrome from intense and prolonged gaming sessions.
- **Neglect of Responsibilities:** Often overlooks daily responsibilities and commitments due to being engrossed in gaming.